

## Introduction

In this lab, you will identify the flow, steps, and stakeholders of a business process and analyze its potential pain points, highlighting any inefficiencies or bottlenecks. You'll visualize the process using Lucidchart, creating a process flow diagram to identify the opportunities for improvement in the process.

Lucidchart is an online tool for creating flowcharts, process maps, organizational charts, and other visual representations of data or processes.

## Scenario

Let's consider a scenario of a (fictitious) online food delivery platform, FreakEats. It allows customers to order food from local restaurants and have it delivered to their doorstep by delivery partners (drivers or riders). Consider yourself a Business Analyst and perform the following tasks.

1. Identification of the current flow
2. Identification of the stakeholders
3. Create a visual representation (process flow) of the current process
4. Identification of the pain points in the current flow
5. Propose improvements
6. Visualize the solution

### Task 1: Identification of the current flow

The current workflow of FreakEats is as follows:

1. The customer places an order through the FreakEats app.
2. The restaurant accepts the order and starts preparing the food.
3. A delivery partner (driver or rider) is assigned to pick up the order.
4. Once the meal is ready, the delivery partner collects it and delivers it to the customer.

### Task 2: Identification of the stakeholders:

Consider the following stakeholders

- Customers
- Restaurant staff
- Delivery partners

- FreakEats support team

### **Task 3: Create a visual representation (process flow) of the current process**

In this task, you'll create a visual process flow diagram that represents the food pickup process of an online food delivery platform.

**Start:** Customer places an order.

**Task:** The restaurant accepts and prepares the order.

**Decision:** Is the delivery partner assigned?

**Yes:** Assigns a driver and estimates pickup time.

**No:** Wait for the availability of a delivery partner.

**Task:** Delivery partner arrives at the restaurant.

**Task:** The delivery partner picks up the order.

**End:** Order is delivered to the customer.

#### **Creating a process flow diagram using Lucidchart**

Click the following link to access the Lucidchart portal.

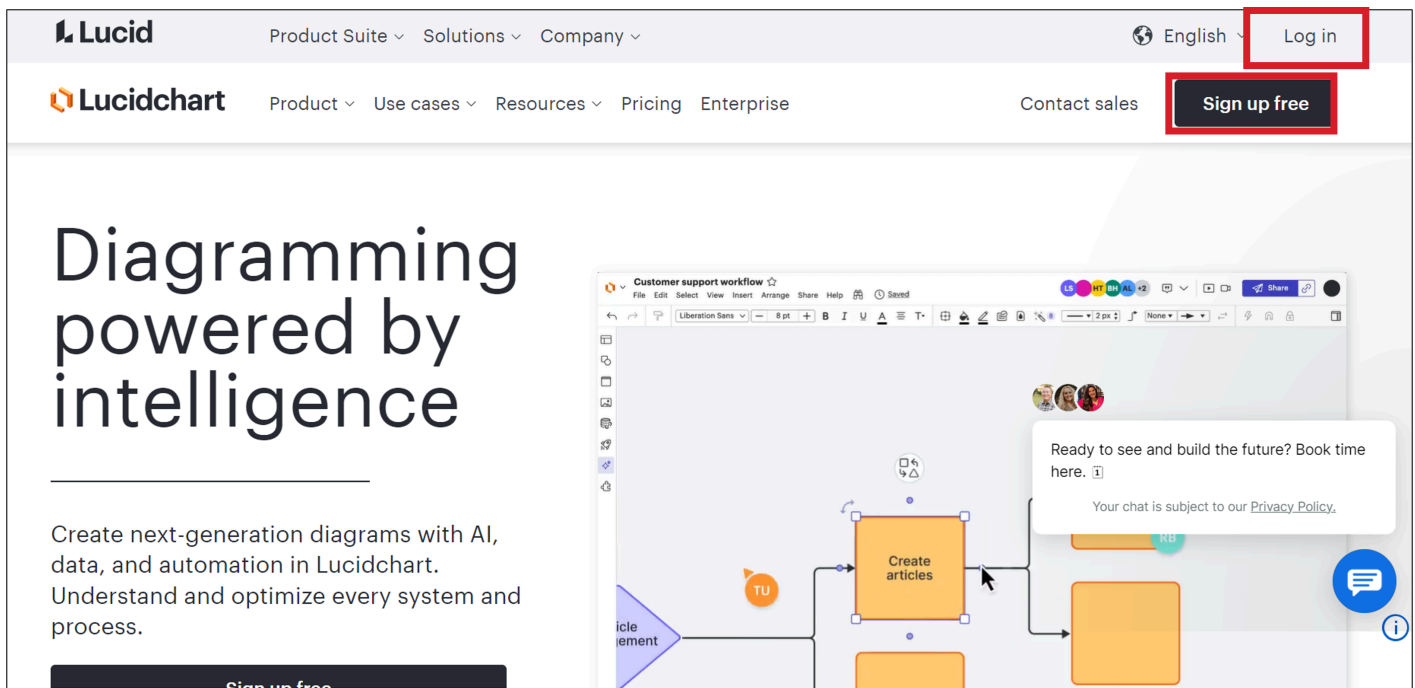
[Lucidchart | Diagramming Powered By Intelligence](https://www.lucidchart.com/pages/?) 

Note: If you cannot access the link, copy the following URL and paste it into the browser.

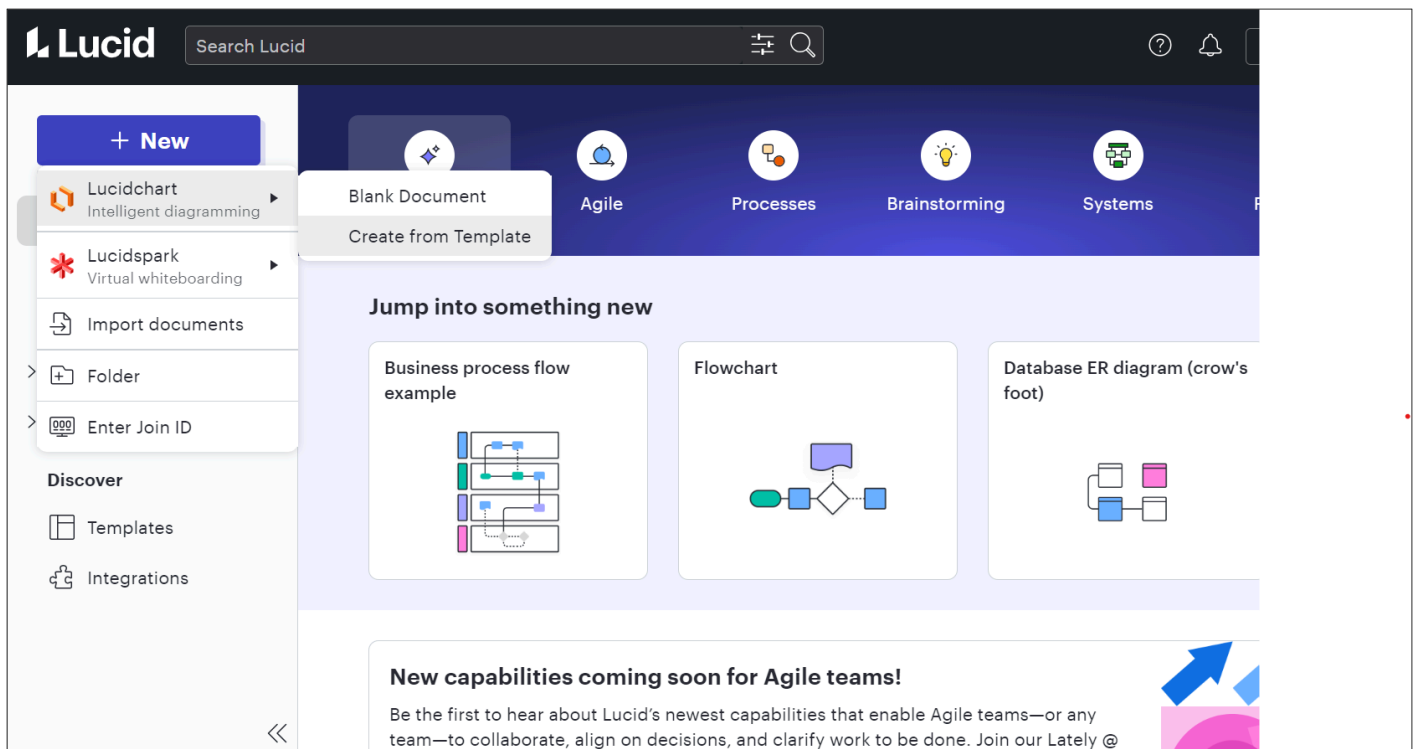
`https://www.lucidchart.com/pages/?`

#### **Step 1: Sign up and log in to Lucidchart**

1. To start with Lucidchart, you need to sign up to create a free account and then log in.

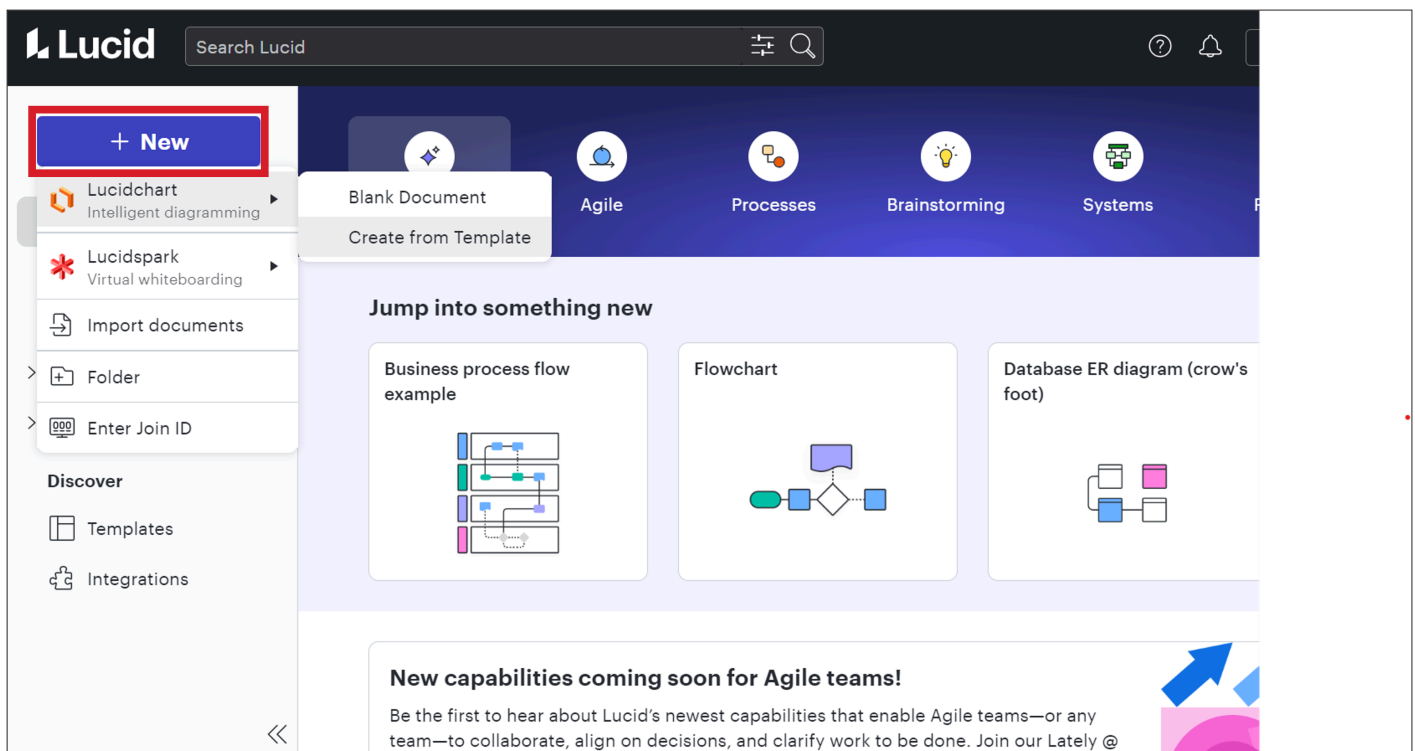


2. Once logged in, you will navigate to the Lucidchart dashboard.

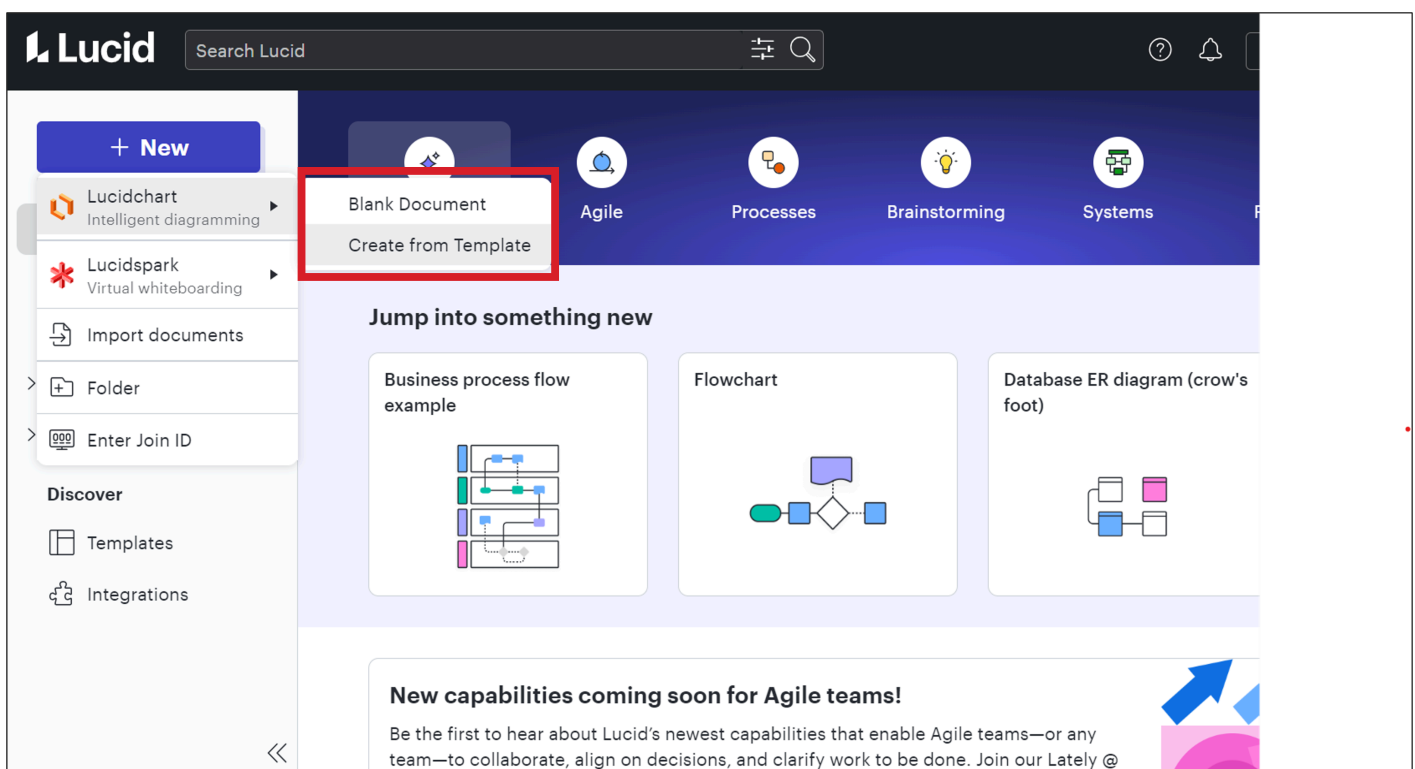


## Step 2: Create a new document

1. Click the **New** button on the left-hand side of the dashboard.



2. Select the **Lucidchart** option to display a drop-down that provides two options. Select the **Blank Document** option.



Note: Alternatively, you can select **Create from Template** and select **Flowchart** to start with a Flowchart template to save time.

3. Save and rename this document with an appropriate name, such as **Process flow for food delivery platform**.

### Rename document

×

Enter your new document name:

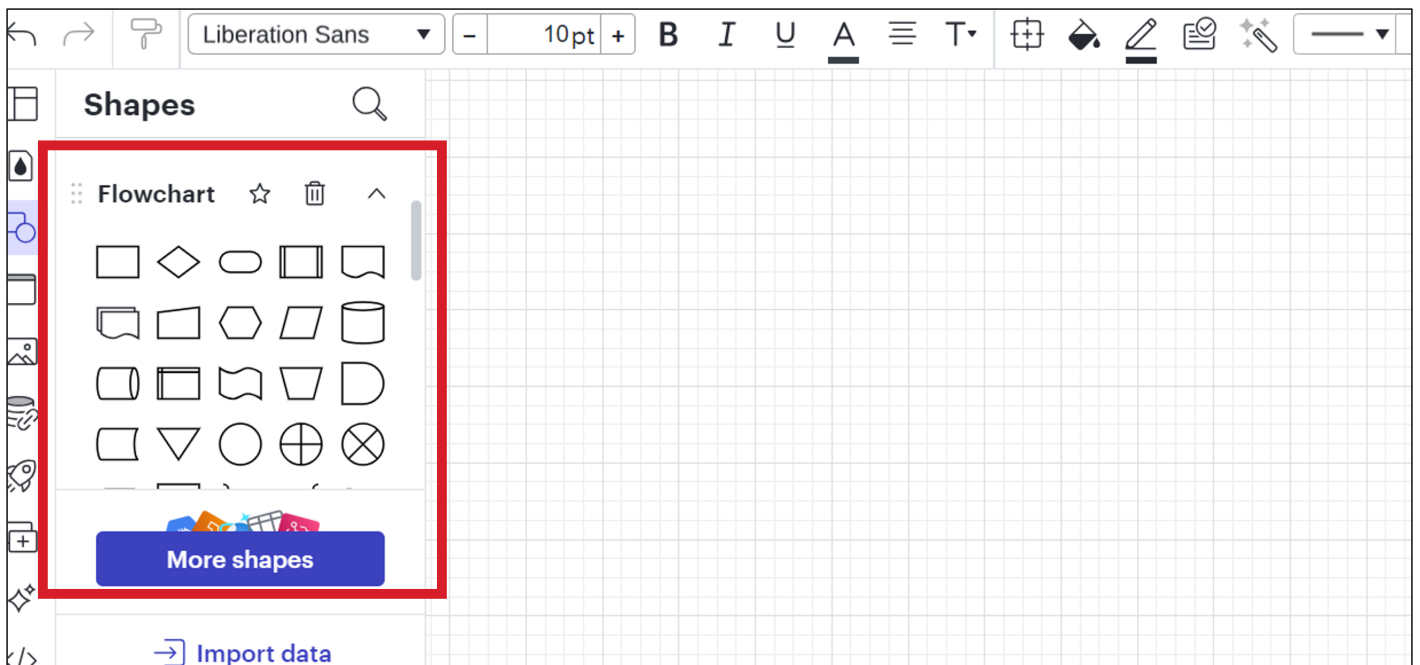
Process flow for food delivery platform'

Set a reminder for this document

Cancel

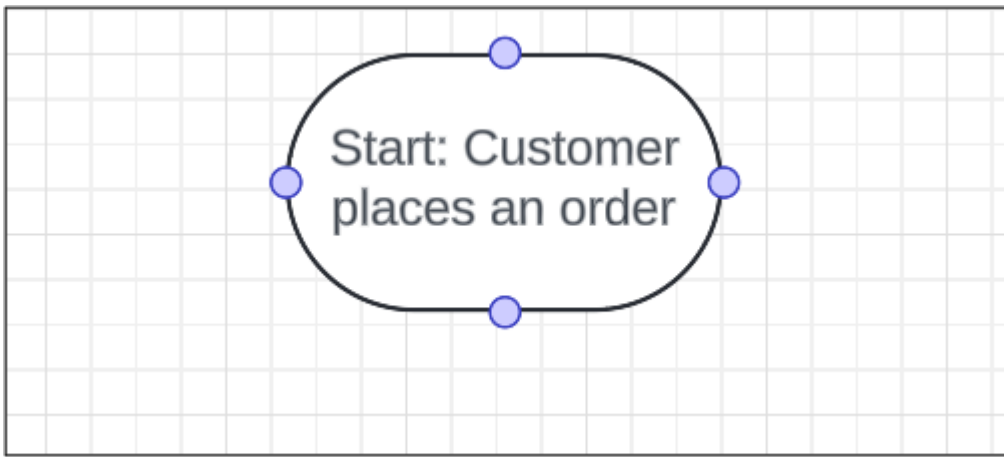
Rename

Note: For this exercise, you will use the shapes from the **Flowchart** section in the **Shapes** panel, displayed on the left side of the dashboard.



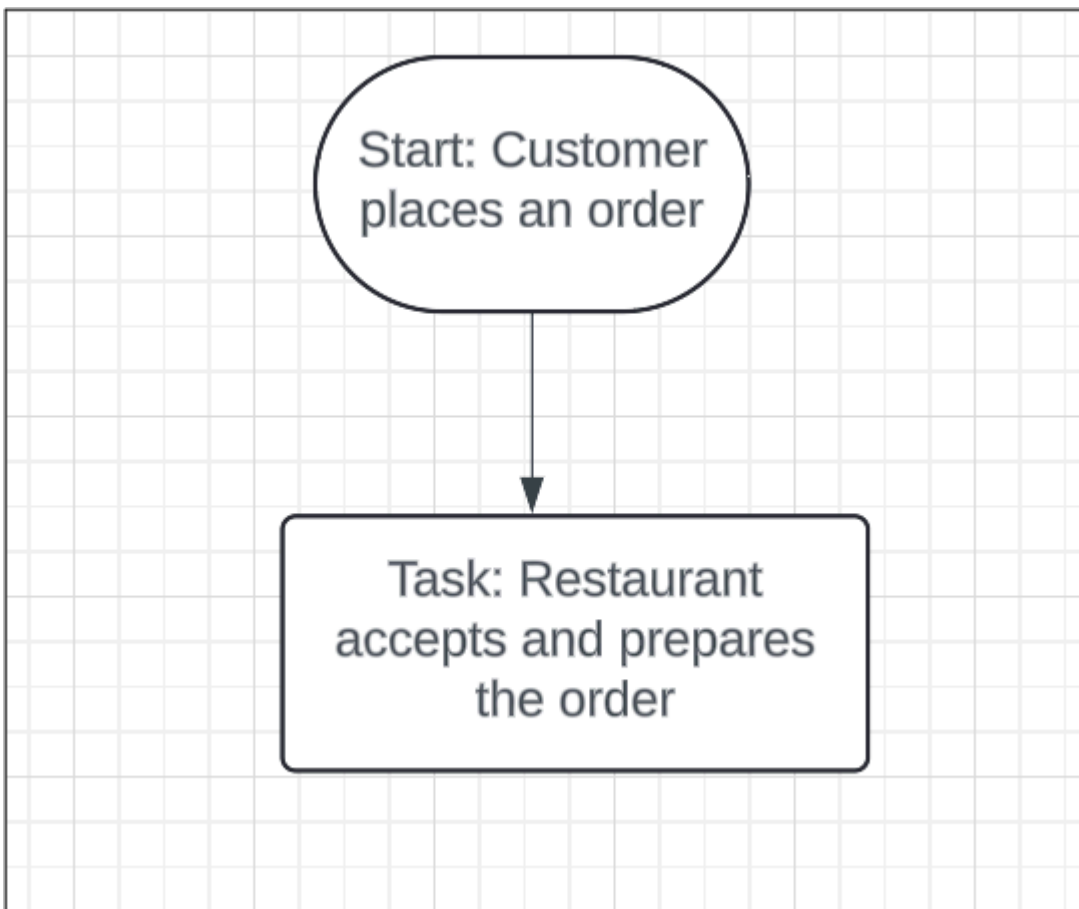
### Step 3: Add the start point

1. Drag an oval shape (that represents 'Start/End') from the Flowchart shapes panel onto your canvas.
2. Add the text ***Start: Customer places an order*** in this shape by double-clicking inside the shape.



#### Step 4: Add the first task (Restaurant accepts and prepares the order)

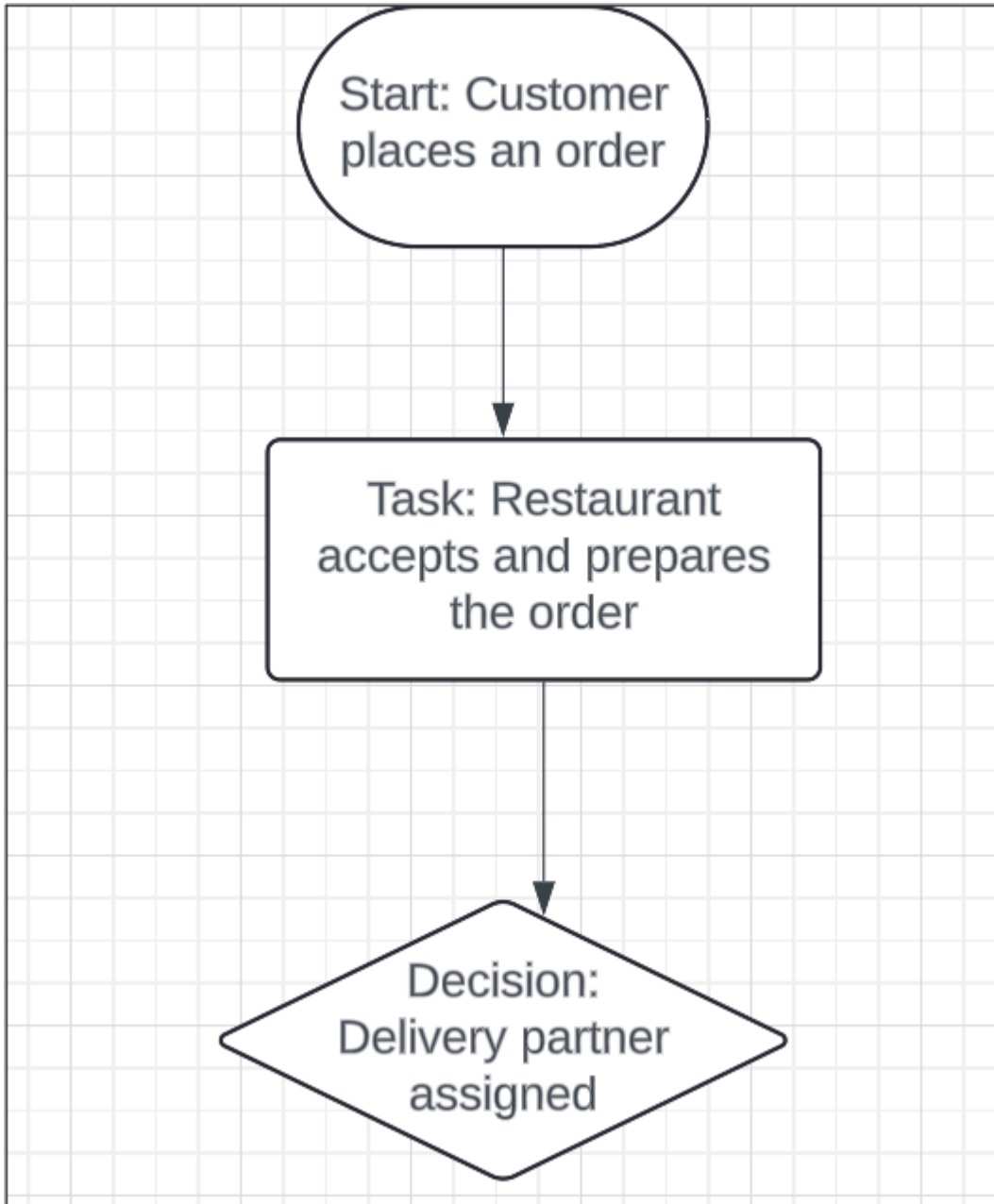
1. Drag a rectangle (representing a task) from the Flowchart shapes panel.
2. Position it below the start oval.
3. Add the text **Task: Restaurant accepts and prepares the order** by double-clicking inside the rectangle.
4. Connect the Start shape to this task: Hover over the oval, then click and drag the small dot on its border to the task rectangle to draw a connecting arrow.



#### Step 5: Add the decision (Delivery partner assigned?)

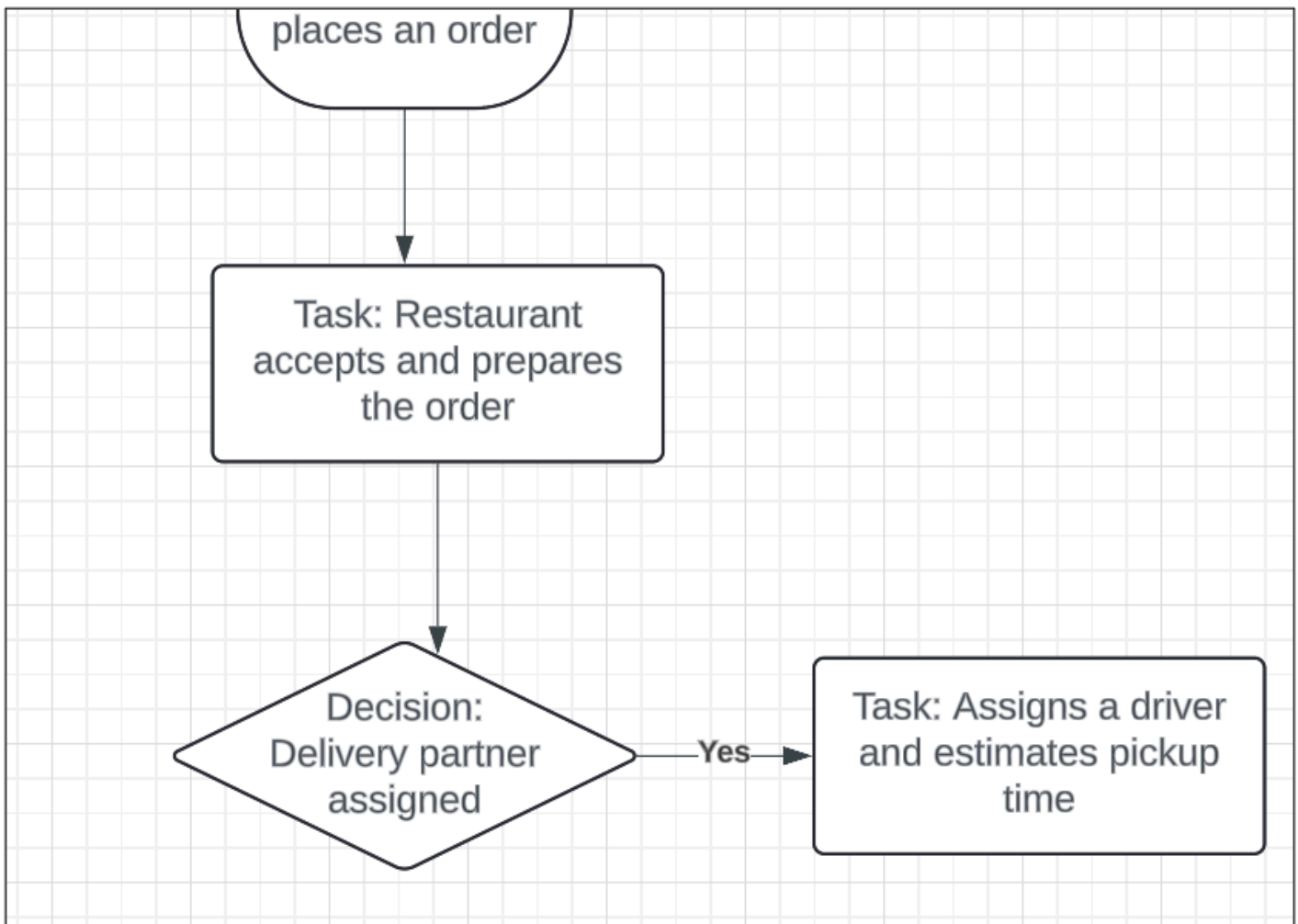
1. Drag a diamond shape (representing a decision) from the Flowchart shapes panel.

2. Position it below the first task.
3. Add the text **Decision: delivery partner assigned?** by double-clicking in the diamond shape.
4. Connect the first task rectangle to the decision diamond by dragging an arrow from the bottom of the task shape to the decision shape.



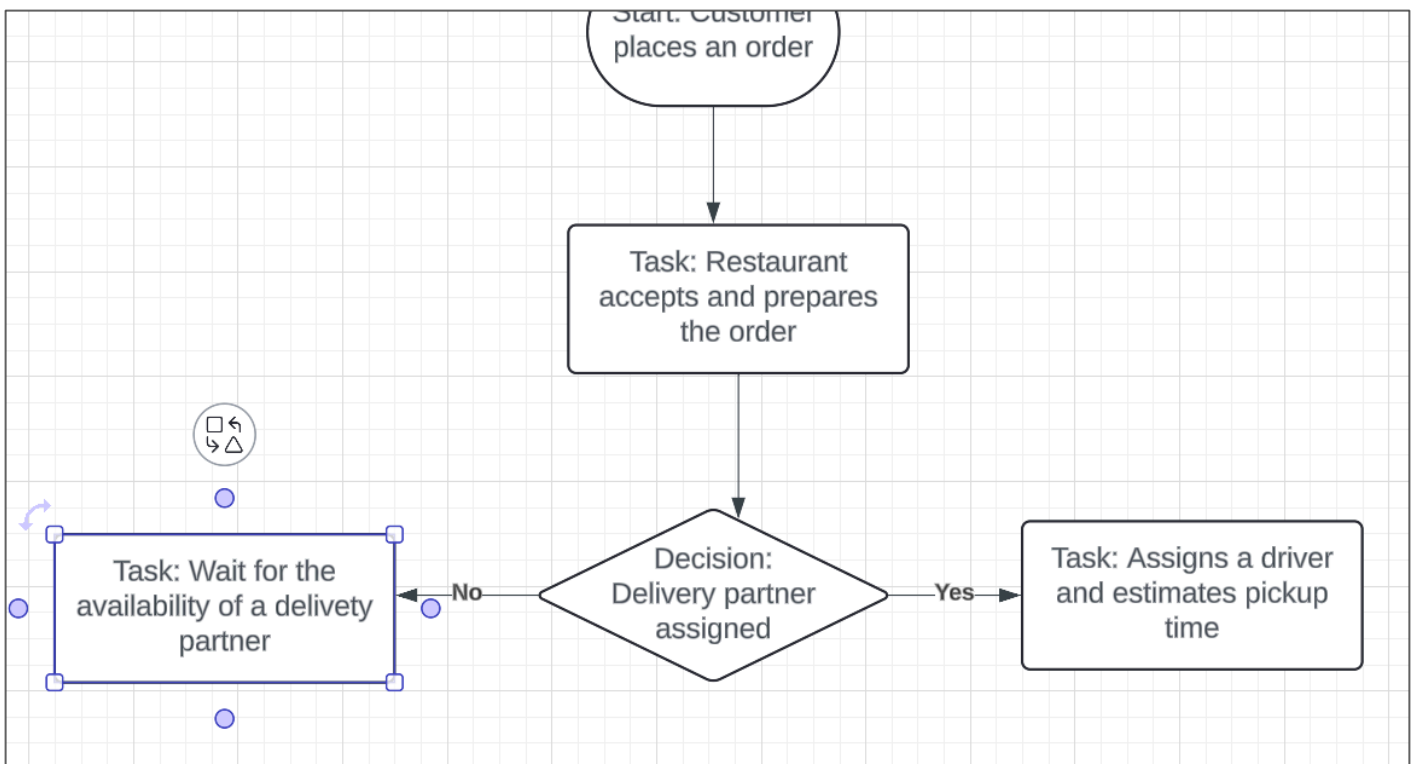
#### Step 6: Add the Yes path (Assigns a driver and estimates pickup time)

1. Drag another rectangle shape onto the canvas to the right of the decision diamond.
2. Add the text **Task: Assigns a driver and estimates pickup time** to this rectangle.
3. Draw an arrow from the decision diamond's right side and connect it to the new task rectangle.
4. Label the arrow **Yes**.



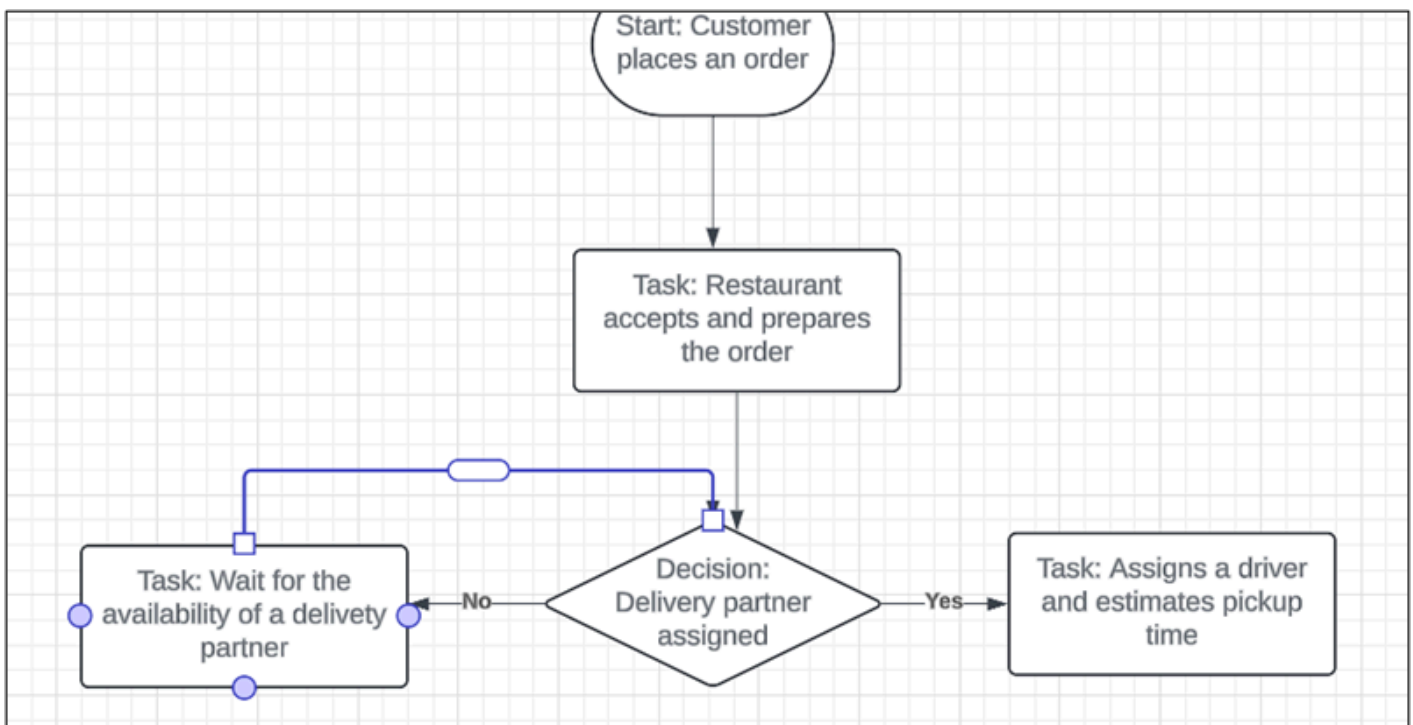
#### Step 7: Add the No path (Wait for the availability of a delivery partner)

1. Drag another rectangle onto the canvas, this time to the left of the decision diamond.
2. Add the text **Task: Wait for the availability of a delivery partner** to this rectangle.
3. Draw an arrow from the decision diamond's left side and connect it to this task rectangle.
4. Label the arrow **No**.



### Step 8: Return from the No path

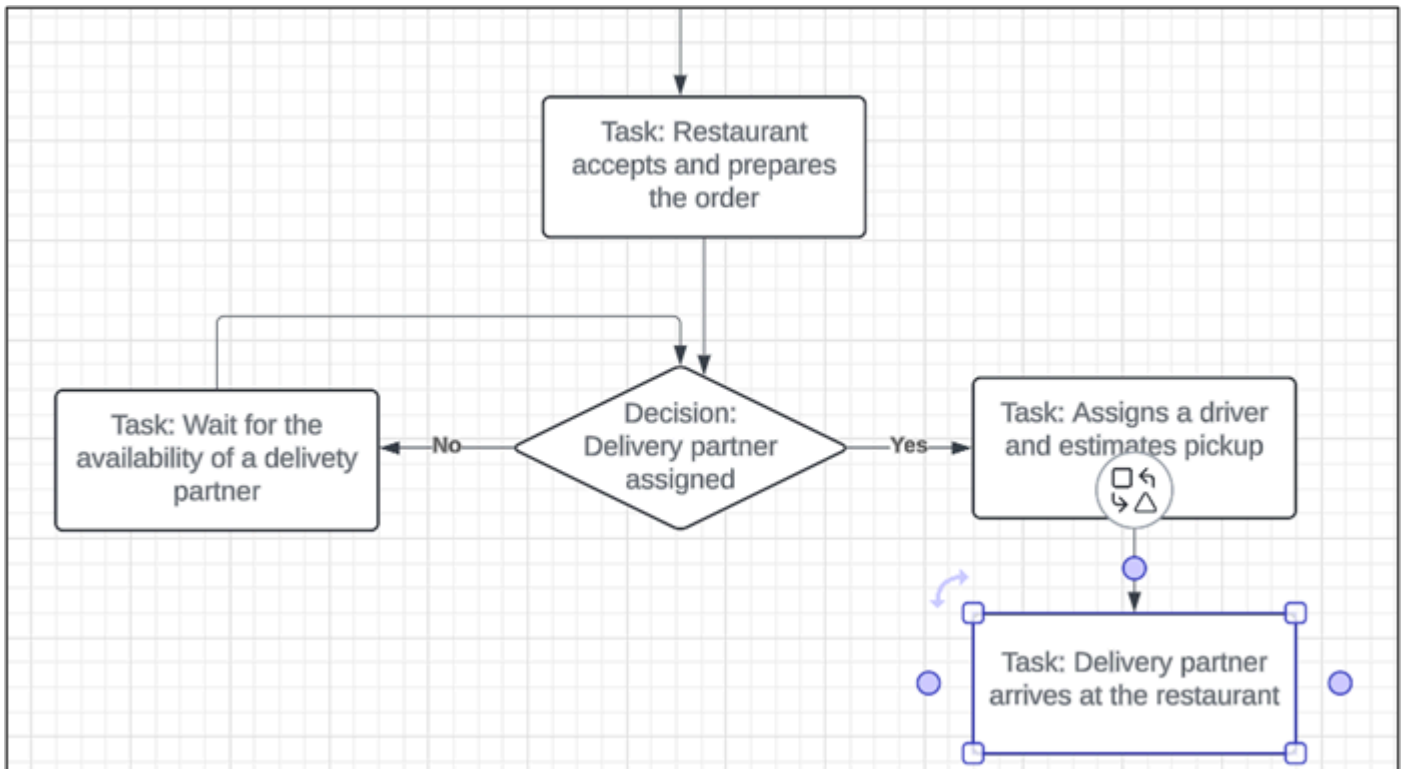
1. Connect the Wait for the availability of a delivery partner task back to the decision point.
2. Draw an arrow from the Wait for the availability of a delivery partner task back to the decision diamond to signify looping back until a delivery partner is assigned.



### Step 9: Add the next task (Delivery partner arrives at the restaurant)

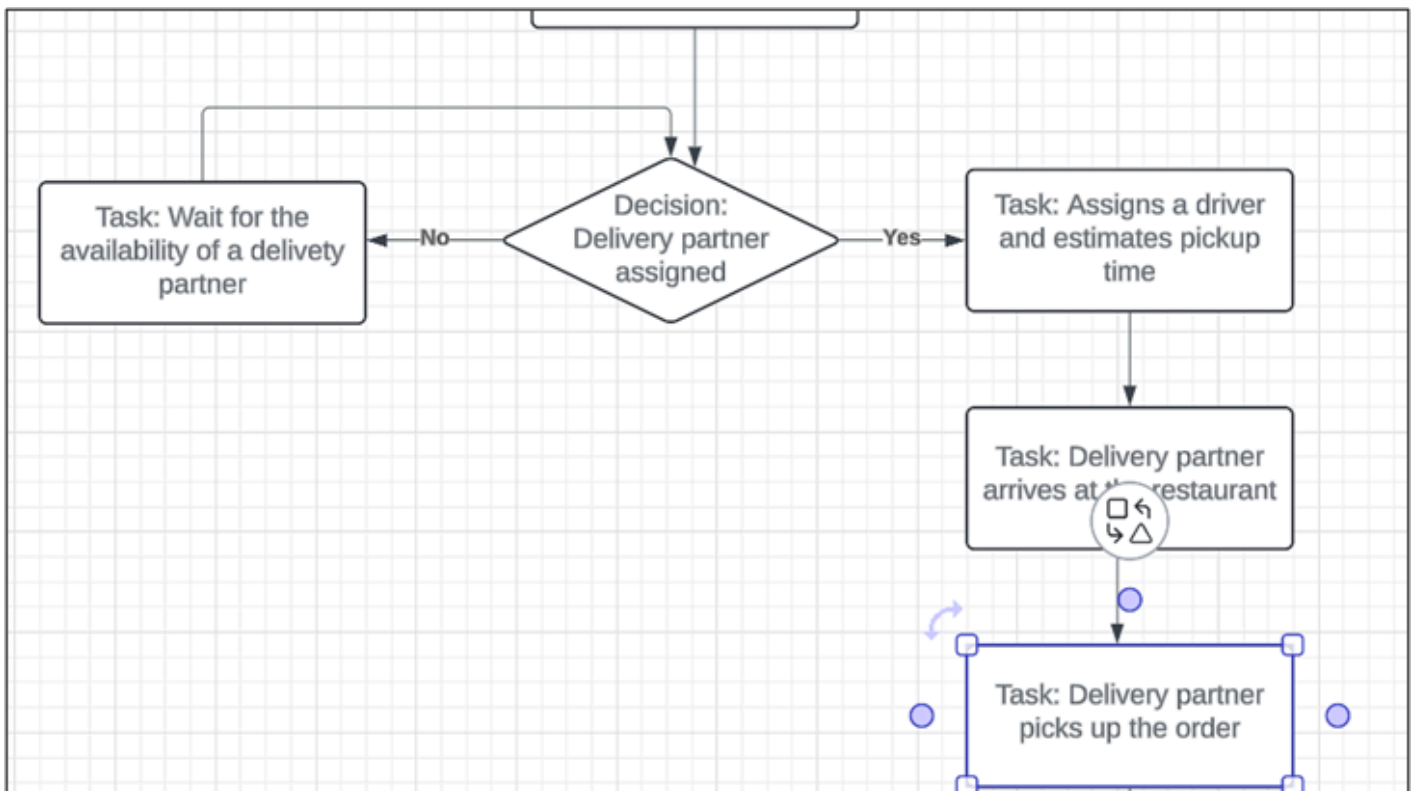
1. Drag another rectangle and position it below the Yes path.

2. Add the text **Task: Delivery partner arrives at the restaurant** in this rectangle.
3. Draw an arrow from the Assigns a driver and estimates pickup time task to this new task.



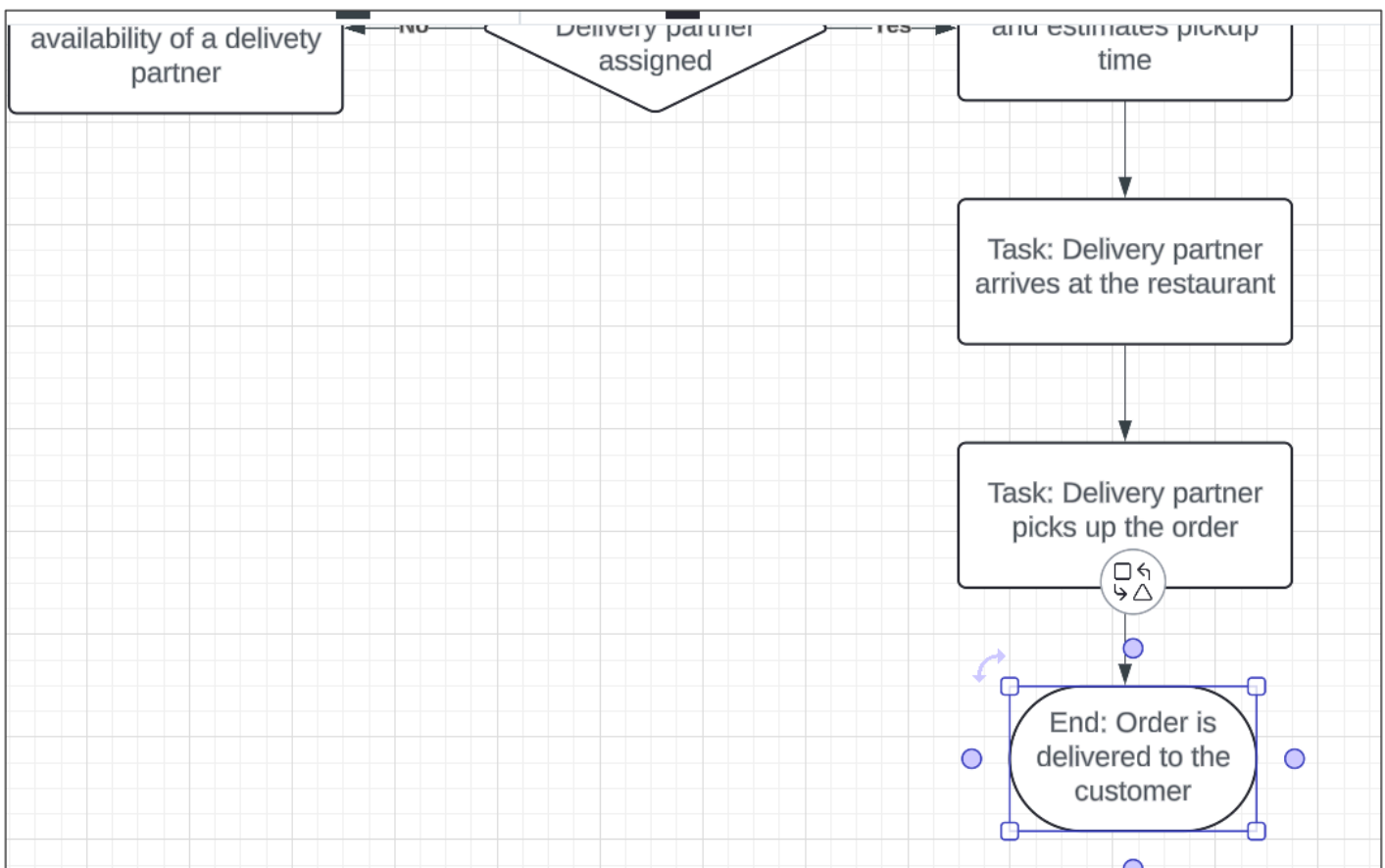
#### Step 10: Add the task (Delivery partner picks up order)

1. Drag another rectangle below the previous task.
2. Add the text **Task: The delivery partner picks up the order** in this rectangle.
3. Connect the two tasks by drawing an arrow from the top task to the bottom task.



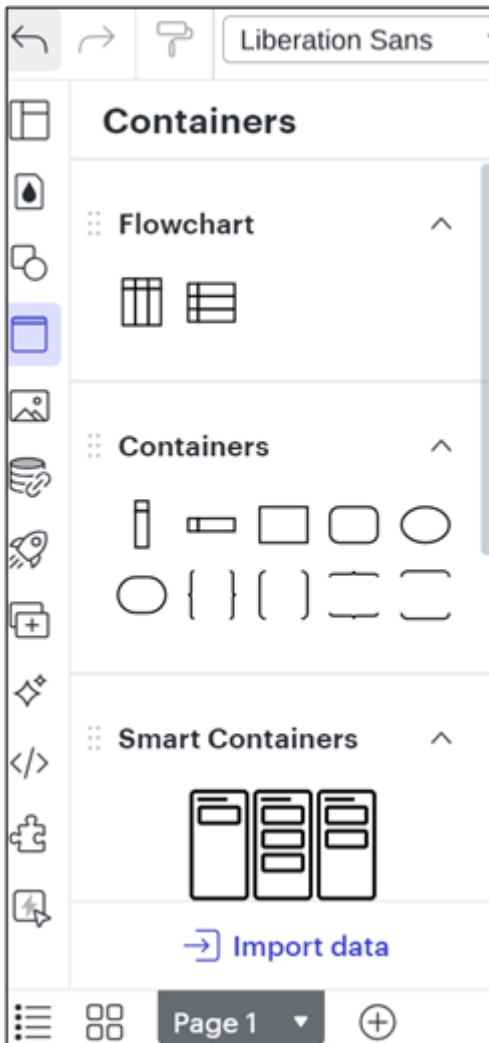
### Step 11: Add the end (Order delivered)

1. Drag an oval and place it below the Delivery partner picks up the order task.
2. Add the text **End: Order is delivered to the customer** in this oval.
3. Connect the Delivery partner picks up the order task to the End shape using an arrow.



**Step 12: Add swim lanes (Optional)** You can add swim lanes to depict who performs each task (Customer, Restaurant, Delivery Partner).

1. In the left toolbar, search for **Containers**.

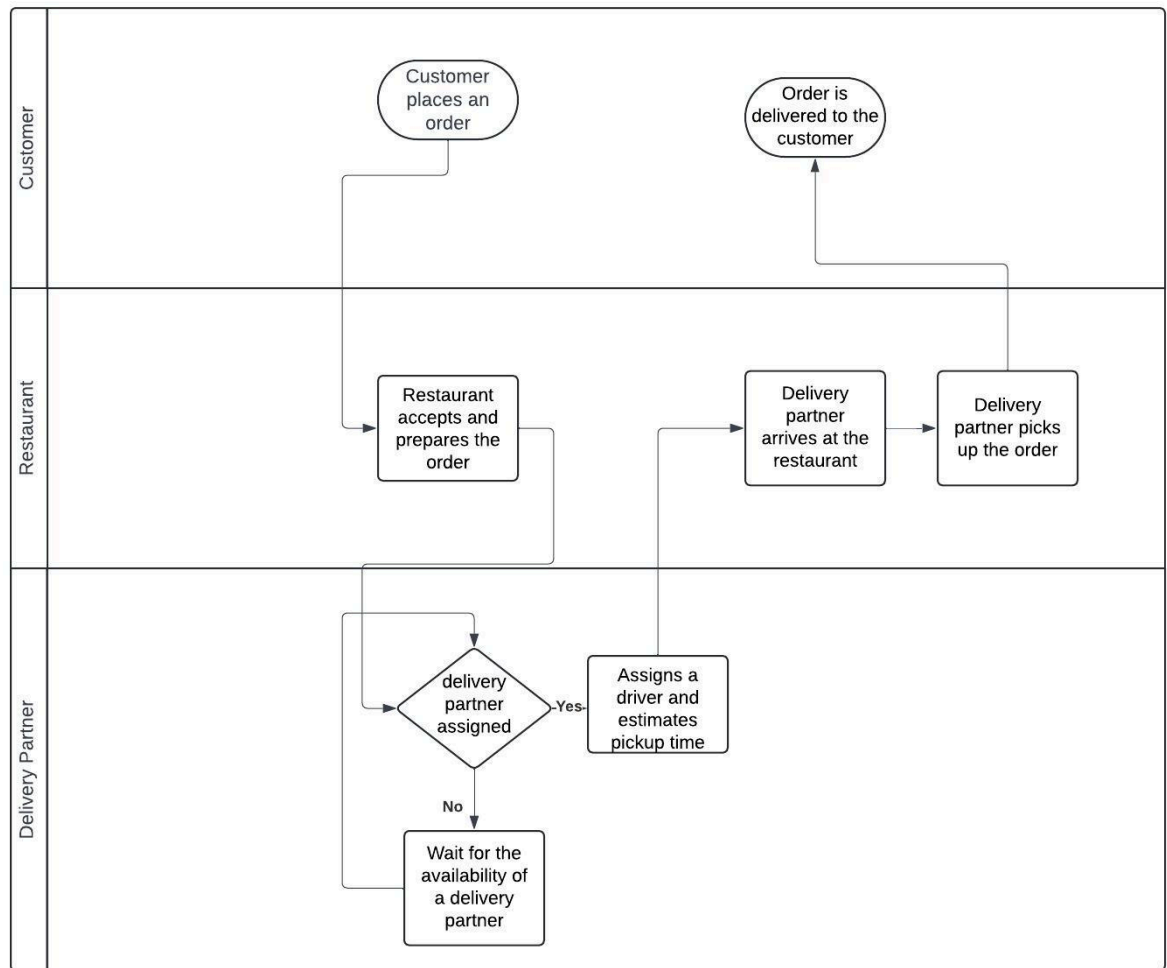


2. Drag the swim lanes onto the canvas.
3. Label each lane as Customer, Restaurant, or Delivery Partner.
4. Move each task into the appropriate swim lane to show who is responsible for each task.

### Step 13: Save and export the diagram

- Once your diagram is complete, select **File > Save** to save your progress.
- To export the diagram, select **File > Export** and select the desired format (PDF, PNG, or JPEG).

The following image depicts the process flow diagram created in the previous steps.



## Task 4: Identification of the pain points in the current flow

Based on the process flow, the following pain points can be recognized:

- **Customers:** Delays in delivery or incorrect estimated delivery times.
- **Restaurants:** Food preparation bottlenecks and communication issues with delivery partners.
- **Delivery partners:** Extended wait times at the restaurant if the order isn't ready and limited parking near pickup locations.
- **FreakEats support:** Managing complaints and resolving miscommunication among stakeholders.

## Task 5: Propose improvements

Based on the identified pain points and the analysis of the current workflow, your task is to suggest at least three improvements to optimize the food pickup process. Consider technological, communication, and operational enhancements.

Here are a few proposed improvements:

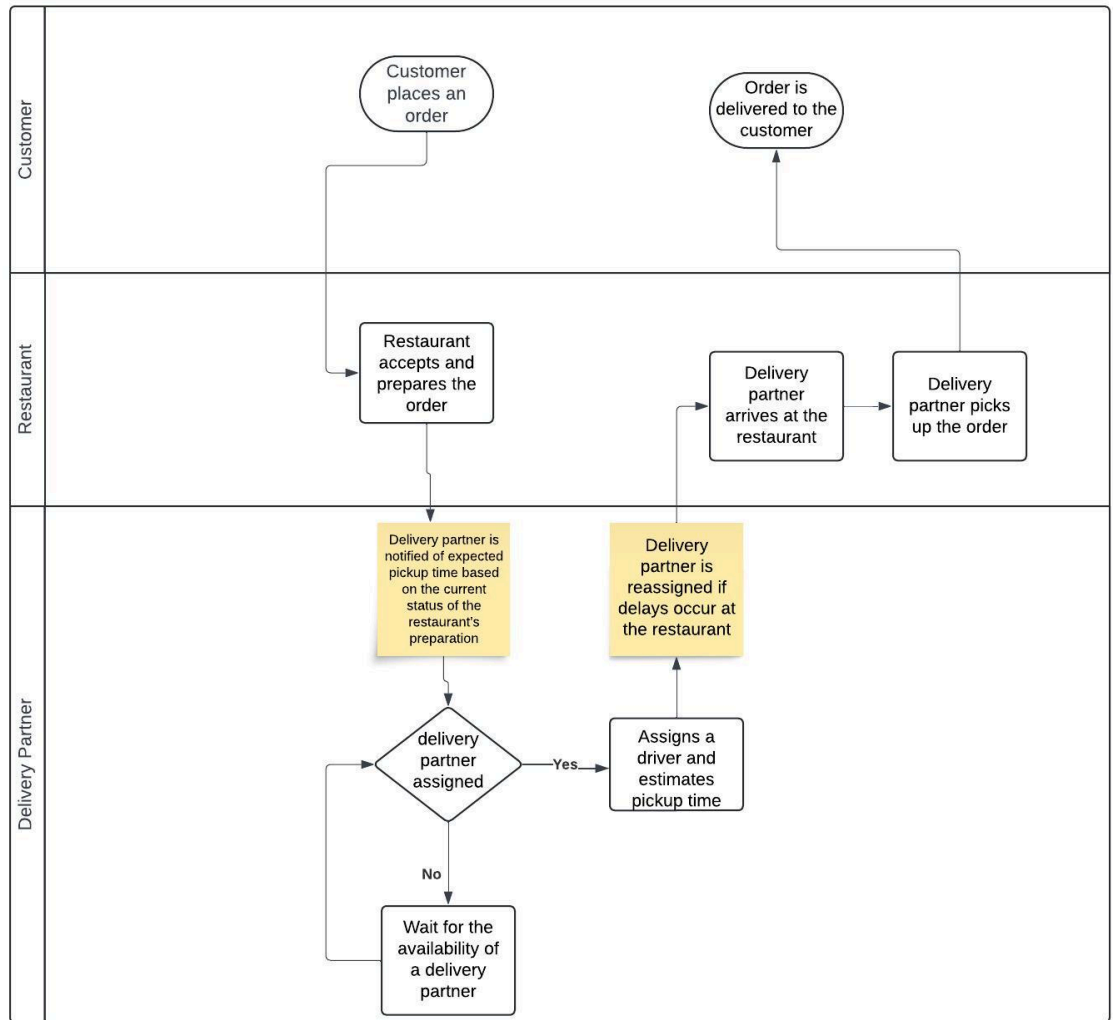
- **Real-time order tracking for restaurants and delivery partners:** This will enable both parties to monitor the order's preparation status, reducing delivery partner wait times.
- **Optimized driver assignment:** Implement machine learning algorithms to assign delivery partners based on their proximity to the restaurant and customer, enhancing efficiency.
- **Restaurant preparation alerts:** Send real-time notifications to delivery partners about any preparation delays, allowing them to adjust their schedules accordingly.

## Task 6: Flow diagram of improved process

Develop a new process flow diagram that integrates the proposed improvements. Compare the original and updated workflows, noting the key differences. Emphasize how each change addresses the previously identified pain points. After incorporating real-time tracking and optimized driver assignment, your updated process flow may include:

- **Task:** The delivery partner receives notifications about the expected pickup time based on the restaurant's current preparation status.
- **Task:** The delivery partner is reassigned if delays occur in the restaurant's preparation process.

Here is a (sample) improved process flow diagram.



## Summary

In this lab, you applied business analysis skills to identify the steps, stakeholders, and pain points of a given business process. By analyzing the workflow, you identified areas for potential improvements and considered improvements. You created a process flow diagram using Lucidchart to visually represent both the current process and the proposed improvements. This lab helped you develop a deeper understanding of business process modeling and how to effectively identify and implement optimizations in real-world scenarios.